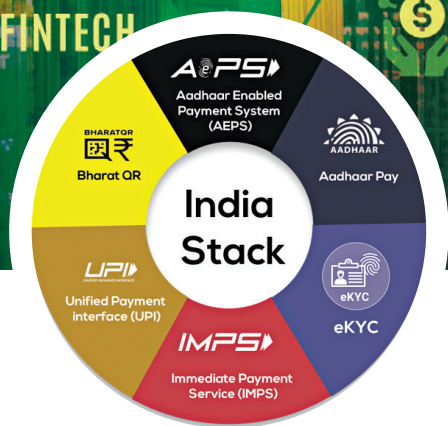




THE INDIA STACK

THE SILENT DIGITAL REVOLUTION THAT'S EMPOWERING EVERYTHING

Satvik Pandey | satvik@digit.in

Picture this – You step out of your house without your wallet, but you don't panic when doing the check to see if you have your wallet with you or not. You know that every transaction – whether it's your morning chai or your cab ride to work – can be handled seamlessly with just a tap on your phone. This is not a futuristic dream. This is India today, powered by the silent, digital revolution known as India Stack.

From making payments to opening bank accounts, from applying for loans to verifying your identity in seconds, India Stack is the invisible force simplifying our daily lives. And yet, most of us use it without realising how deeply embedded it is in our routines. Let's break down this digital infrastructure and see how it's making everything faster, smoother, and more accessible.

The power of UPI

Remember the days when transferring money meant filling out bank slips or dealing with cumbersome net banking interfaces? That's history. The Unified Payments Interface (UPI) transformed money transfers from a multi-step process into something as effortless as sending a WhatsApp message. With UPI, money moves instantly, 24/7, without the need for an account number or IFSC code. A simple UPI ID or phone number is enough.

How UPI simplifies daily transactions:

- Split bills without awkwardness – Whether it's a dinner with friends or a group vacation, UPI apps let you split expenses instantly.

- No cash? No problem! – From street vendors to large retailers, nearly everyone accepts UPI payments.
- Recurring payments made easy – Subscriptions, rent, and even loan EMIs can be automated, reducing the hassle of monthly reminders.
- Security you can trust – With multi-factor authentication, including device binding and biometric verification, UPI is safer than traditional card transactions.

It's no surprise that UPI now handles billions of transactions every month, outpacing credit and debit card payments combined. It's fast, frictionless, and has democratised digital payments like never before.

e-KYC: Opening accounts and getting loans in minutes

Banking used to be synonymous with bureaucracy – endless paperwork, multiple visits, and weeks of waiting. Then came e-KYC (electronic Know Your Customer), a game-changer in digital verification. Powered by Aadhaar, e-KYC allows financial institutions to verify identities in seconds instead of days.

Why e-KYC matters:

- Opening a bank account? Done in minutes! – Earlier, opening an account meant producing physical documents and in-person verification. Now, thanks to e-KYC, you can do it all from your phone.
- Faster loans and credit approvals – Startups like Razorpay and Paytm leverage e-KYC to instantly

verify borrowers, making personal loans and microcredit accessible within minutes.

- Financial inclusion at scale – Millions of underbanked Indians now have access to financial services, thanks to remote, paperless verification. e-KYC doesn't just make things quicker – it makes financial services available to everyone, even those without traditional paperwork or a physical banking presence in their area.

Aadhaar and the Digital Infrastructure of the future

If UPI and e-KYC revolutionised transactions and verification, Aadhaar laid the groundwork for India's digital identity ecosystem. As the world's largest biometric identification system, Aadhaar has over 1.3 billion users, providing a secure, verifiable, and universal identity.

What's next for Aadhaar?

- Seamless government services – From gas subsidies to pension payouts, Aadhaar ensures benefits reach the right people without leakages.
- One-tap authentication – Services like DigiLocker allow users to access digital versions of their driving licenses, PAN cards, and educational certificates instantly.
- Borderless digital economy – As Aadhaar authentication expands, expect smoother integration of banking, insurance, and healthcare services, eliminating redundant KYC processes. Aadhaar's interoperability with multiple services is paving the way for a